

A life of lava

For the next 25 years, this is exactly what Katia and Maurice did. Together, they traveled all over the world and climbed around half of the world's active volcanoes. In a time before robots and drones, they were able to see and record incredible scenes of lava flows, pyroclastic debris, and volcanic craters. They created a huge collection of videos and more than 300,000 photographs, which could be used in movies, books, and documentaries.

Katia and Maurice became the most well-known volcanologists in the world. Each adventure paid for the next one, but their work also helped to teach governments how to keep communities safe near volcanoes and inspired new generations of volcanologists.



A pyroclastic flow is a glowing cloud of superheated gas, ash, and rocks, which moves downhill very quickly.



**Mount Unzen,
Japan**

Along with more than 50 others, Katia and Maurice were killed by a pyroclastic flow while visiting Mount Unzen as it erupted in 1991.

New land is formed as the lava cools.

Above ground the molten rock is called lava.

A volcano is a place where molten rock, ash, and gases escape from beneath the Earth's surface.

Studying volcanoes helps scientists to predict eruptions.

Deep underground the molten rock is called magma.